New ransomware wreaks havoc
REvil group encrypted the data of hundreds of businesses using an exploit in management software.
https://dgit.in/jul21-66

Volkswagen fined $1 billion
Volkswagen, BMW fined $1 billion for colluding to make dirtier cars.
https://dgit.in/jul21-80

Funge this

We don't care how you break it down, NFTs suck

Team Digit | feedback@digit.in

Forced memes biforced again as NFTs

Within a hiccuping bull run, crypto FOMO manifests itself in a new avatar. If you are staying under a rock or using the pandemic as an excuse for your reclusivity, a Non-fungible token (NFT) is a unit of data stored on a blockchain that certifies a digital asset to be unique and therefore not interchangeable. In simple terms, a unique type of cryptocurrency, or rather a token, is not identical or interchangeable. Think of them as digital collectibles, limited edition items that just do not happen to have any physical reality.

Cryptocurrencies functioning on the proof of work model are energy sinkholes. Bitcoin mining alone emitting around 37 million tonnes of CO2 each year. The quantity of energy necessary to produce and maintain a blockchain is mind-boggling, consuming as much energy as entire countries. However, there is nothing in this world that humans cannot make worse, and crypto appears to be no exception with the advent of NFTs. The thing is that even Cryptocurrencies and NFTs are just the beginning of what is the decentralised internet, where all the apps and services that are currently in the cloud services offerings of big tech companies can be distributed and anonymised at the grassroots level. This means that the infrastructure to run the internet is dubious, cheap, ill secured machines sharing space with crypto miners, botnets, ransomware and whatnot. Before rushing to make digital collectibles, there is a simple question that you need to ask, do you even need to base digital collectibles on distributed ledger technologies? We have had DRM and copy-protected files for ages. The Fimo app offers limited time filters as digital collectibles. It is interactive and ephemeral, and there is absolutely no crypto involved! Everyone and their grandmothers are rushing to mint NFTs, including Reddit, Katy Perry, Porsche, Shohaib Akhtar, Twitter, Marvel, Burberry, and Jay-Z, all have launched NFTs since the time we started writing this sentence.

NFTs have been nothing but a burden on the blockchains they're running. In 2017, with the launch of Cryptokitties, there was a significant increase in traffic on the ethereum blockchain, increasing the number of pending transactions and at one point accounted for 25% of the transactions on the network. This accounted for a significant increase in energy consumption and higher rates of congestions on the network, ultimately driving up the gas prices of the network. Cryptos are really a functional thing, not an investment vehicle. You need it for when Uber is banned by the local government, or when hyperinflation hits, or when you really need to make cross border transactions to skirt around international embargos, or firewalls. These new activities slapped on top of cryptos just slow down the transactions on the underlying blockchain, and do not add any real value. Think of them as the lame top apps on the Play Store, and they really are the same, all the sleazy ones, that's what most NFTs look like. There is nothing of real value here.